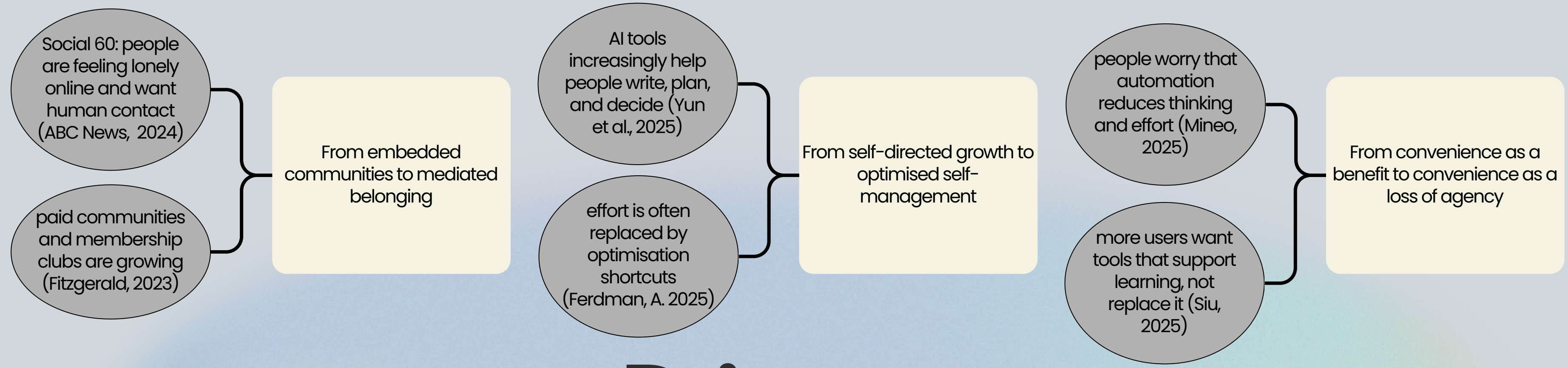
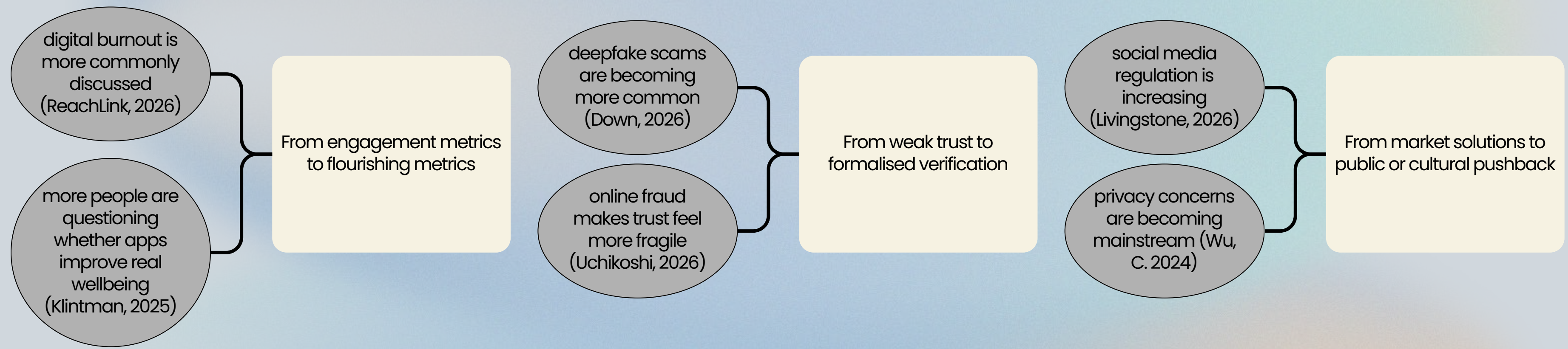


Your Future *Reimagined* ● A2 INFO30005



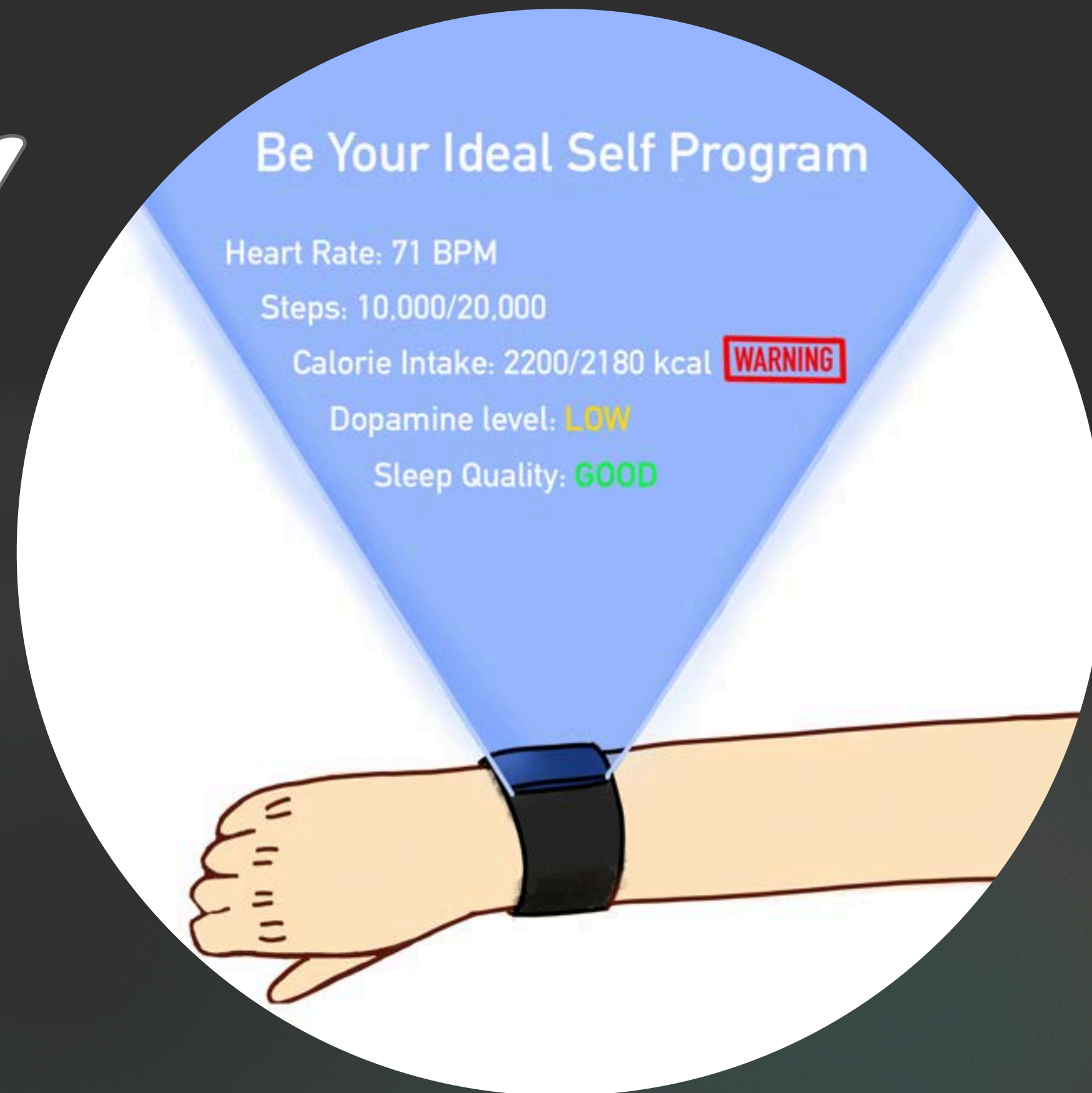
Drivers



Forecast *1*

The Optimised Self

In the 2030s, identity and self-worth become increasingly shaped by tracking, optimisation, and performance culture, making personal growth harder to separate from pressure, measurement, and external expectations.



Forecast 2

The Belonging Economy

In the 2030s, belonging increasingly shifts from something naturally formed in everyday life to something mediated, organised, and sometimes sold back to people through platforms, brands, and paid communities.



Forecast³

The Friction Movement

By the mid-2030s, a cultural shift emerges against frictionless living, and more people begin to value effort, reflection, and meaningful struggle as necessary parts of growth, connection, and a good life.

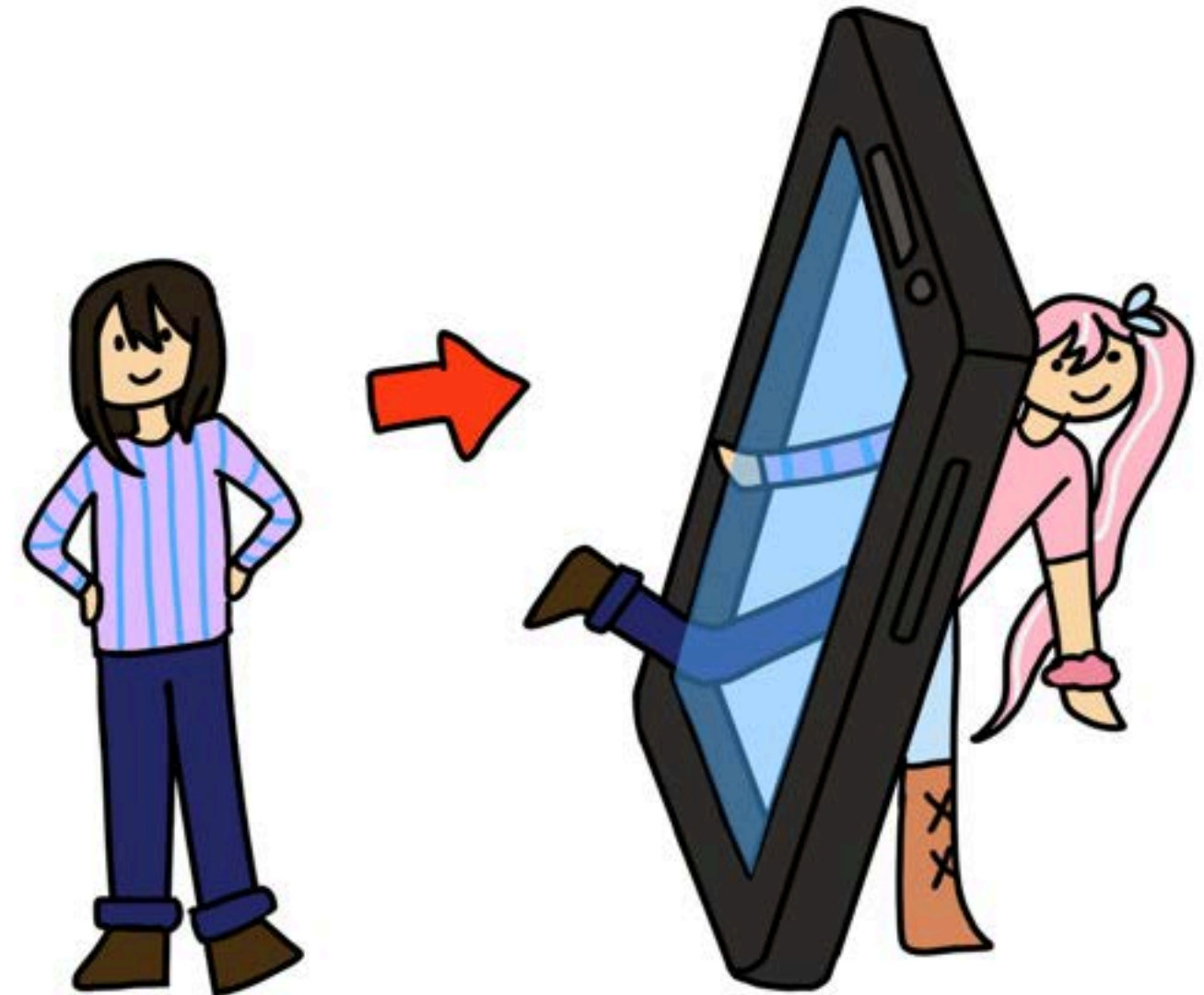
**Chosen
Forecast**



Forecast 4

The Identity Fracture

By the late 2030s, identity becomes more flexible but also more fragmented, as people manage multiple versions of themselves across different digital systems, social settings, and forms of verification.



Scenario

Frictionless future community, 2038

Mainstream Smart City

Algorithmic optimization
Frictionless automation
Efficiency-first design
Seamless integration



from seamless optimisation to
calibrated convenience

Friction Future Community

Calibrated convenience
Intentional pace
Human-centered rhythm
Reflective infrastructure

AI assists, but does not replace

Capability, reflection, and connection are protected by design

Belonging is infrastructure, not a premium service

Not every difficulty is a design failure

A Day in Community

07:00 — Choose your day mode
Home AI offers support modes such as “focus”, “recovery”, or “social”, but it cannot build a full plan for the day. Residents must choose their own priorities before the system begins assisting them.

07:30 — Walk the slower route
The fastest route is always available, but many streets are designed to reward walking, pausing, and noticing others. Benches, shared noticeboards, and slower crossings create encounters that pure efficiency would remove.

10:30 — Wait through the reflection gap
For major choices, the system introduces a mandatory pause before confirmation. Residents can use this gap to review trade-offs, ask others, or sit with the decision.

14:30 — Borrow before buying
When residents search for rarely used tools or appliances, the system first shows what can be borrowed, tested, or shared locally. Buying is still possible, but ownership is not the default first step.

16:00 — Fix before replacing
If something breaks, the default pathway is repair rather than replacement. Residents are guided to a community repair room before a replacement request is approved.

18:30 — Join without paying for intimacy
Evening meals, discussion circles, and neighbourhood gatherings are organised as common services, not premium experiences. There are no VIP layers, sponsored hosts, or ranking systems shaping who belongs.

A snapshot of what a 'Friction Zone' will look like in the future

Artefact from the Future

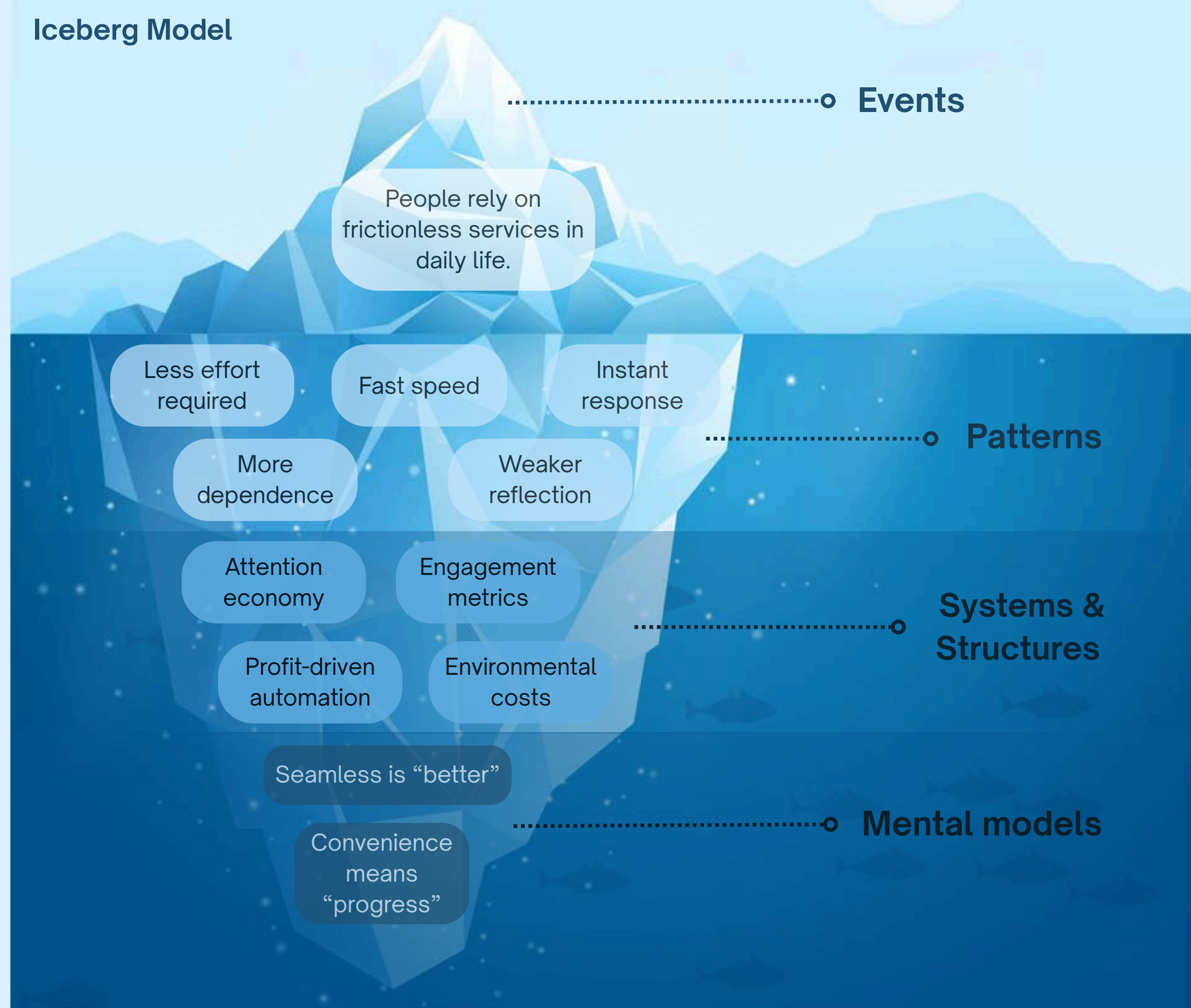


Impacts of Tech

Drivers Behind the Need for Friction Zones

This iceberg shows that frictionless digital life offers a clear positive impact by making everyday tasks faster and easier. However, underneath this convenience, there are deeper trade-offs. The same systems that reduce burdens can limit opportunities for human reflection, judgement, and active participation. At the deepest level, these systems are built on the belief that seamless experiences are always better and that effort is a design flaw. To overturn this assumption, we must move toward a 'Friction Zone' to restore the human agency.

Iceberg Model



Impacts of Tech

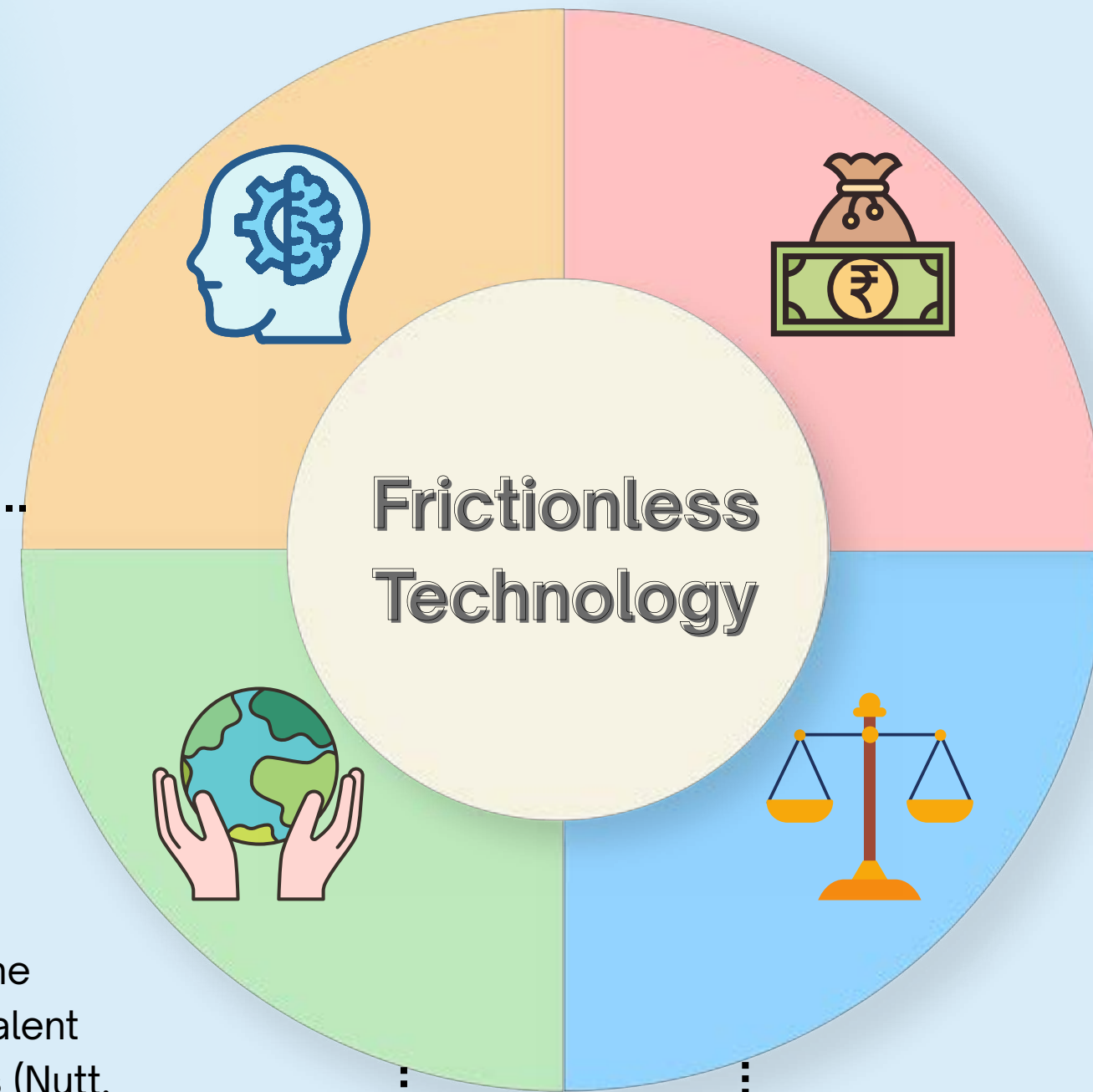
Key tensions and obstacles

Cognitive impact

Frictionless systems can lead to cognitive offloading as the human brain naturally follows the easiest path. A study found that students using ChatGPT scored 11% less than the traditional learning group on a delayed retention test (Barcaui, 2025), suggesting that seamless access to information is actually an obstacle to problem solving and absorption of knowledge in the long term.

Environmental impact

Effortless digital experiences rely on hidden environmental infrastructures. In the US alone, the water consumed annually by AI servers is equivalent to the water usage of 6 to 10 million households (Nutt, 2025). While appearing clean and invisible to users, these systems cause substantial environmental damage out of sight.



Economic/labour impact

Automation is often deployed where it is profitable, not where it is most necessary. It is estimated that 40% of jobs globally and 60% in advanced economies are exposed to AI (Cazzaniga et al., 2024). This creates an uneven distribution of risk and benefit. Instead of prioritising dangerous labour, it replaces human work that still carry meaning and social value.

Ethical impact

As generative content becomes easier to produce, harms such as deepfakes can spread before effective protections are in place. Spain has proposed fines of up to 35 million euros for companies that fail to label AI generated content (Reuters, 2025). This again shows regulation is often reactive and that technology is scaling faster than regulation can respond.

Tech implications

- **Preferred future:** In 2038, 'Friction Zones' are government funded spaces established within Victoria residential areas. Frictionless technology such as AI is restricted by architectural signal blocking in order to restore human agency and cognitive focus. These zones provide shared facilities for manual hobbies and allow people to spend more time in nature. Local committees help manage these spaces and host skill sharing sessions where people teach each other manual skills without digital shortcuts. Outside these zones, technology still appears in everyday life, but only as an assistant not replacing human judgement.



The primary user goal shifts from speed to agency. People will favor a tool based on how much control it leaves in their hands.



Governments begin to protect people's attention as a protected public resource from constant digital interruption.



People have the right to be offline and untracked for data training. What happens in the Friction Zone, stays in the Friction Zone.

Tech implications

Digital design in the preferred future



Restricted mode: Designers need to make sure that physical boundaries also work in the digital world. Devices can detect when a user enters a Friction Zone and automatically switch to a restricted mode. Predictive algorithms and non-essential notifications are turned off at the border. This gives attention back to the person.



Simple community tools: Friction Zones still need coordination, but the tools look different. Digital systems are run by local committees and designed as simple noticeboards, booking systems, and tool sharing libraries. Addictive loops will be avoided. They are only here to support activities in the physical world.



The Cognitive Harm Tax: Companies are not going to walk away from attention extraction without consequence. Government will charge a Cognitive Harm Tax to companies that generate excess profit through frictionless design. This money will flow directly into a public fund for building and maintaining Friction Zones.



Offline protection: Real human connection is the core of the Friction Zone. Designers must ensure that nothing happening inside is treated as data for AI training. This requires fully local, offline hardware and systems that do not upload behavioural data.

AI declaration

- Our team used Claude AI to brainstorm current issues relating to self-improvement. It listed several different aspects for us to consider, which provided direction for our later research.
- Our team used Chat GPT 5.4 to make AI posters for visual inspiration of our artefact. These images were not used as the final artefact, but we brought them to the tutorial and received feedback on them. This later inspired the design of our final poster.
- ChatGPT 5.4 was used to organise messy research of the team done on an infinite whiteboard on figma to brainstorm ideas and back them up with evidence. This helped us identify drivers and categorise forecasts.
- Chat GPT 5.4 was used to summarise lecture notes. This helped us revisit key ideas more efficiently and ensure that our assignment was on track.
- Google Gemini 3 Flash was asked whether an iceberg model would be suitable for showing the impacts of frictionless technology. It said that the model was suitable for showing the hidden drivers of the system. It aligns with what we had in mind, so we decided to follow this advice.
- Google Gemini 3 Flash was also used to recommend websites that provide free iceberg model templates. Its top suggestion was Miro, which it said had many iceberg model templates. However, when we actually went to the website and searched for those, there were almost none. In the end, we used Google search instead and chose an iceberg image from Freepik as the background.
- ChatGPT 5.4 was used to organise references in APA 7th format. However, there were still some small problems, such as issues with capitalisation and incorrect dates, so we had to compare its results with the format provided on the University of Melbourne website and make corrections.
- ChatGPT 5.4 was also used to classify ideas about frictionless technology impacts. Its categorisation matched the ideas well, so we decided to use it.

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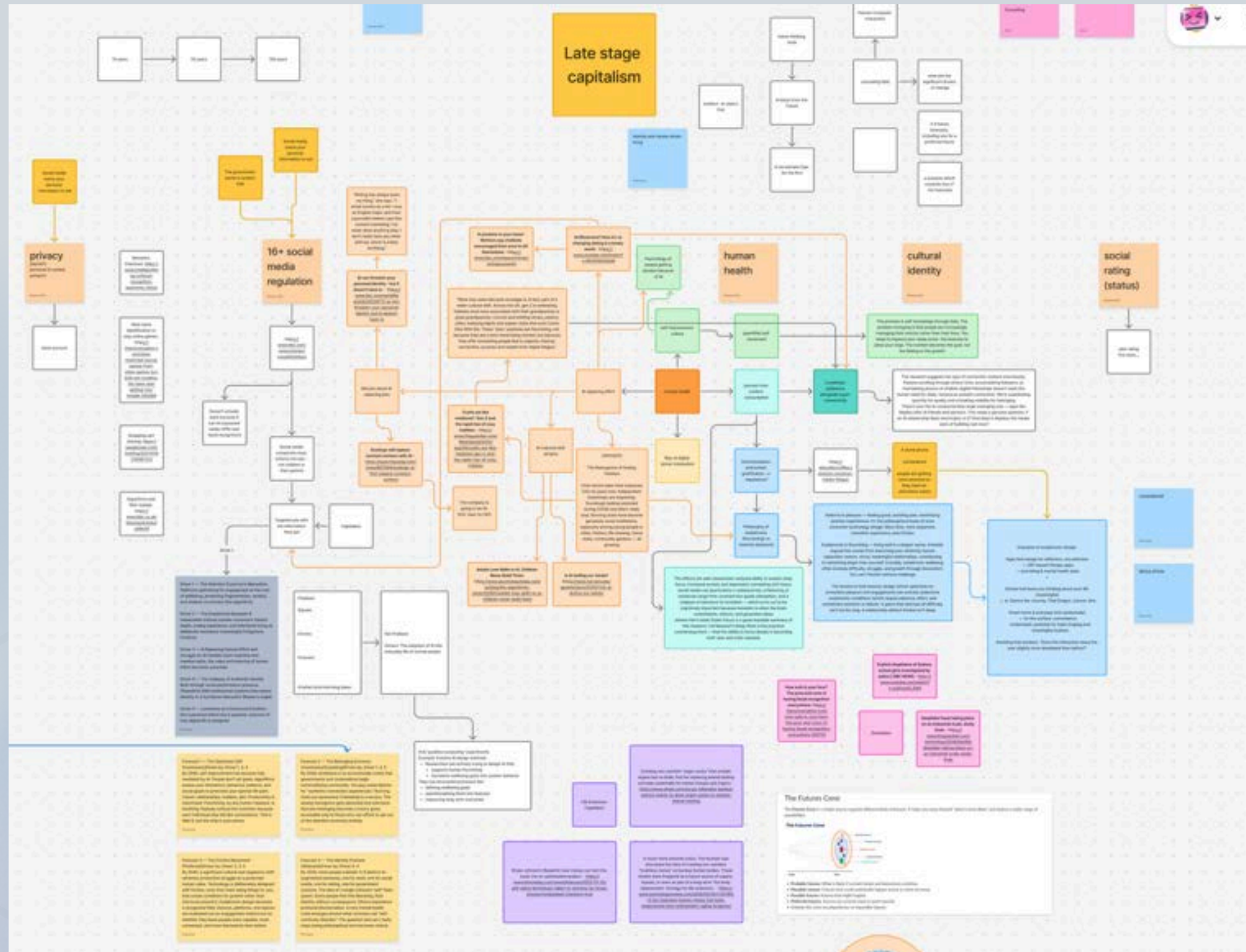
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Supporting Materials.

<https://www.figma.com/board/SVKWOVvA7hnes2YugszrMi/AIP-group-work?node-id=0-1&t=GkCRt3SG32C54fl6-1>

Please Click the Link



The signals that we found through our desk research

Signals and Research



Problem	Solution
People who are visually impaired often struggle to find their way around a building. They often get lost and frustrated.	Design a way for people who are visually impaired to find their way around a building. The solution should be simple, easy to use, and not require any special equipment.
People who are visually impaired often struggle to find their way around a building. They often get lost and frustrated.	Design a way for people who are tactile to find their way around a building. The solution should be simple, easy to use, and not require any special equipment.
People who are visually impaired often struggle to find their way around a building. They often get lost and frustrated.	Design a way for people who are hearing to find their way around a building. The solution should be simple, easy to use, and not require any special equipment.
People who are visually impaired often struggle to find their way around a building. They often get lost and frustrated.	Design a way for people who are blind to find their way around a building. The solution should be simple, easy to use, and not require any special equipment.



Problem 1
The Friction Project: A Design Thinking Process

Problem 2
The Friction Project: A Design Thinking Process

Problem 3
The Friction Project: A Design Thinking Process

Problem 4
The Friction Project: A Design Thinking Process

Problem 1

Problem 2

Problem 3

Problem 4

Problem 1

Problem 2

Problem 3

Problem 4

Problem 1

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Problem 4

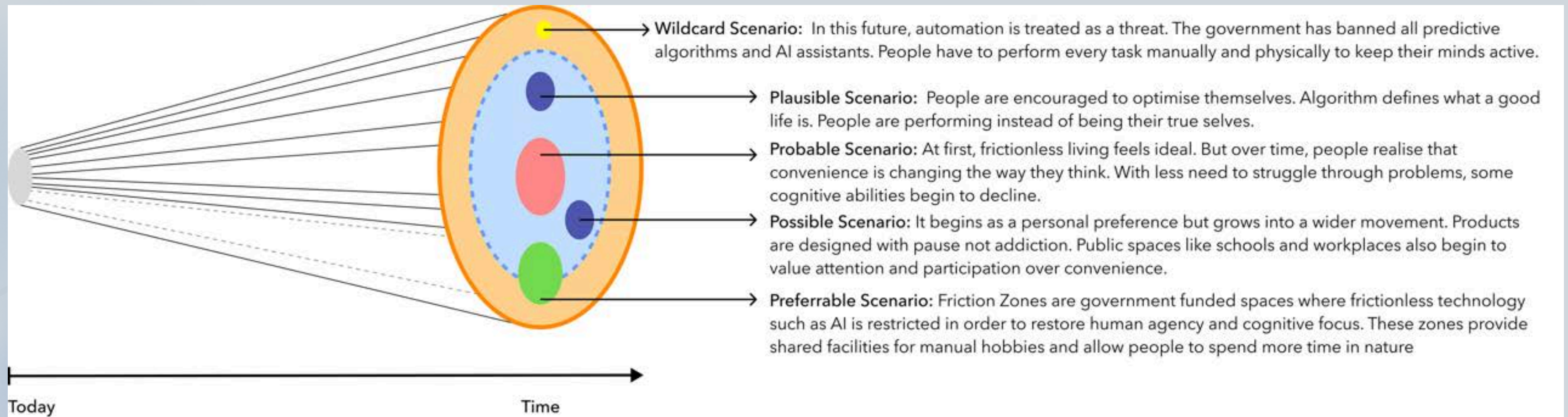
Problem 1

Problem 2

Problem 3

Problem 4





Future Cone

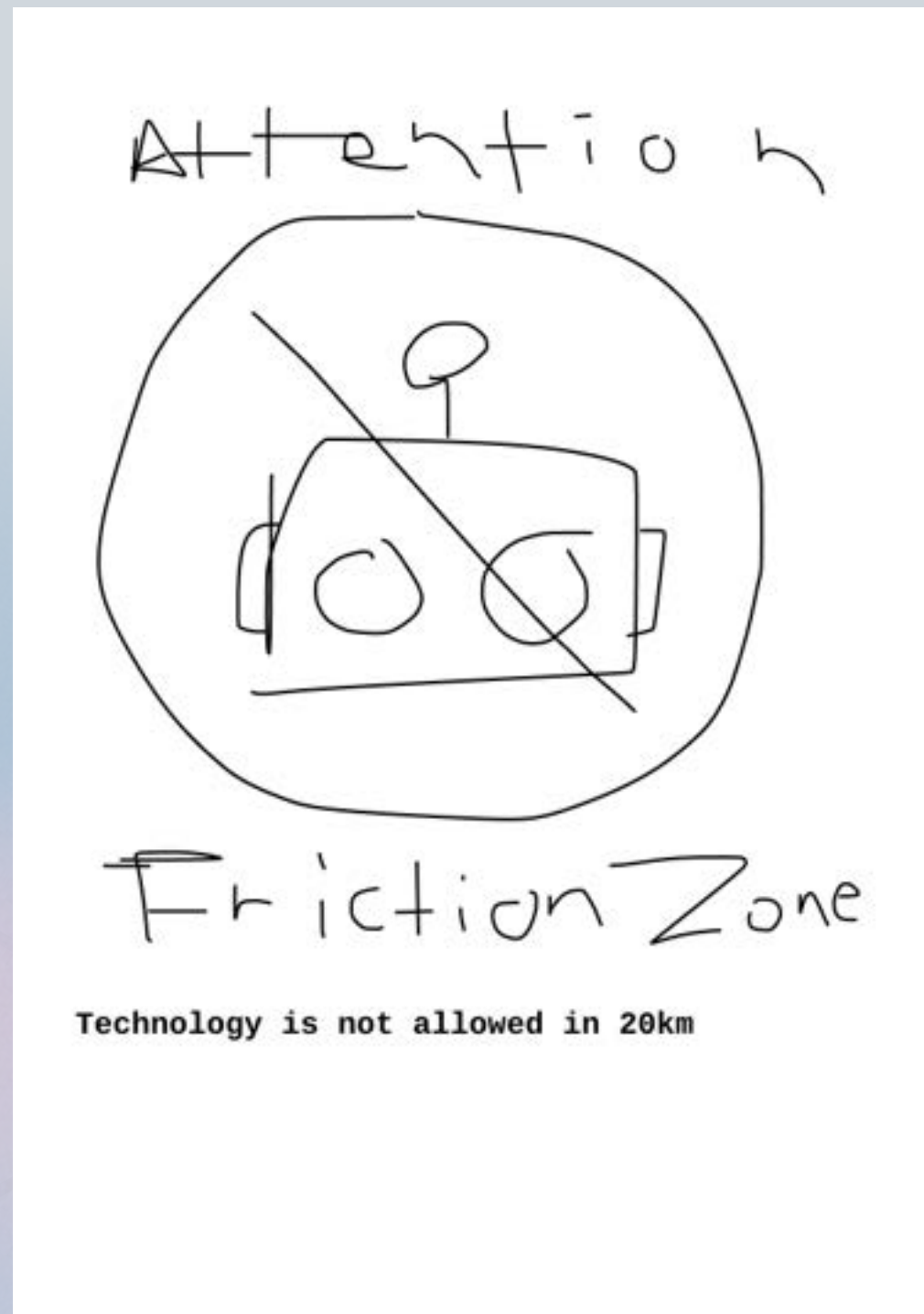
Signals

Title	URL	Signal
Is AI dulling our minds?	https://news.harvard.edu/gazette/story/2025/11/is-ai-dulling-our-minds/	“A recent MIT Media Lab study reported that “excessive reliance on AI-driven solutions” may contribute” to “cognitive atrophy” and shrinking of critical thinking abilities.”
‘Crafts are like medicine!’: Gen Z and the rapid rise of cosy hobbies	https://www.theguardian.com/lifeandstyle/2025/sep/04/crafts-are-like-medicine-gen-z-and-the-rapid-rise-of-cosy-hobbies	“What may seem like pure nostalgia is, in fact, part of a wider cultural shift. Across the UK, gen Z is embracing hobbies once more associated with their grandparents or great grandparents”
Artificial love? How A.I. is changing dating in a lonely world	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ROOftMUSKkM	There have been a rise in people dating and being in a relationship with AI chatbots
Report finds younger Australians feeling more lonely and disconnected	https://www.facebook.com/abcnews.au/videos/report-finds-younger-australians-feeling-more-lonely-and-disconnected/1109663873564043/	Social 60, campaign on Tiktok to spend 60 minutes a day socialising face-to-face with someone else

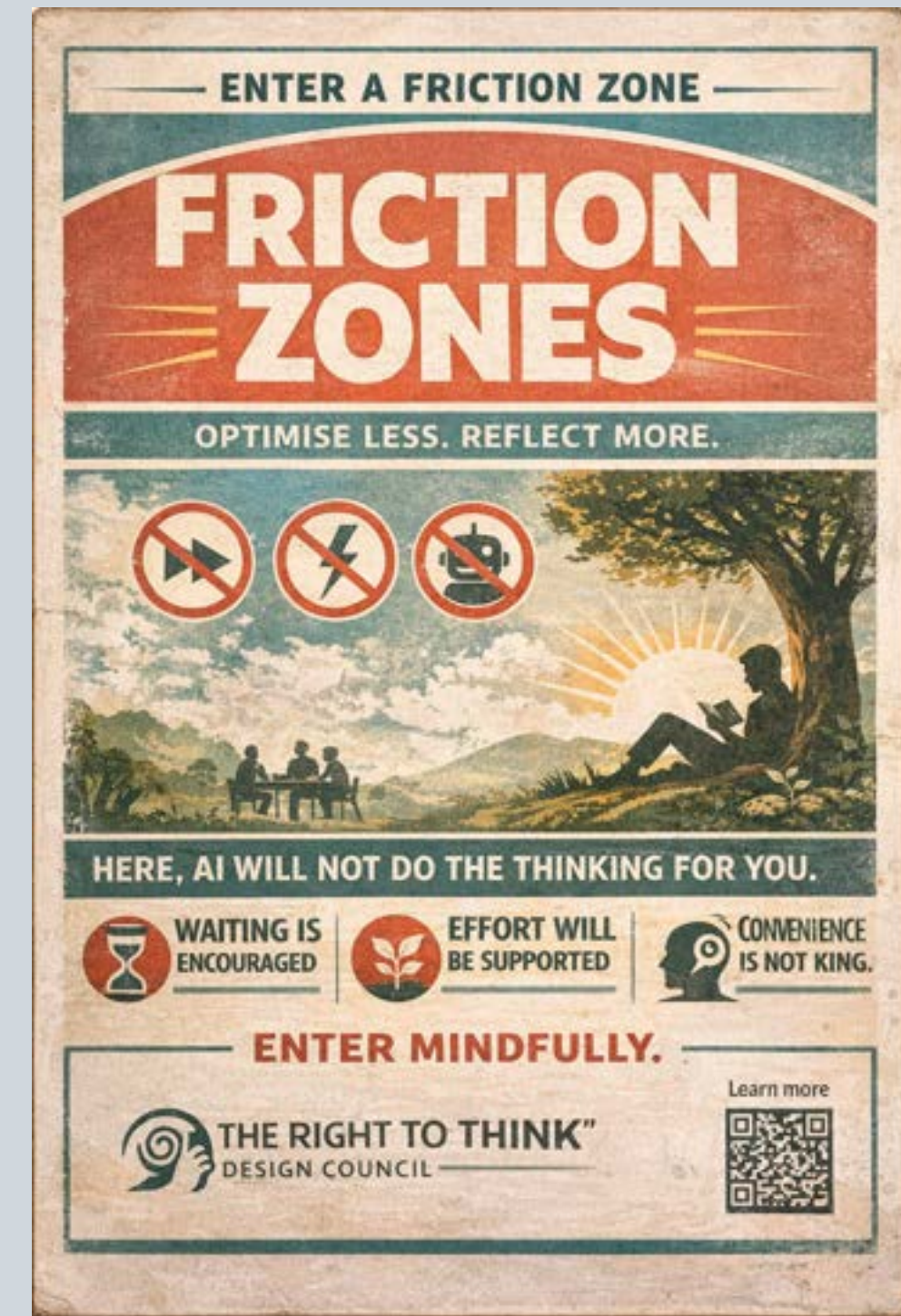


Previous artefact idea for forecast. In the future, as an effort to become add more friction to the process of using AI (an originally frictionless activity) and exercise the user's mind, puzzles are put before the prompt can be sent.

Artefact from the Future



Sketch of final artefact idea



AI generated poster visualisation

Artefact from the Future



Close ups of the artefact outside of the mockup

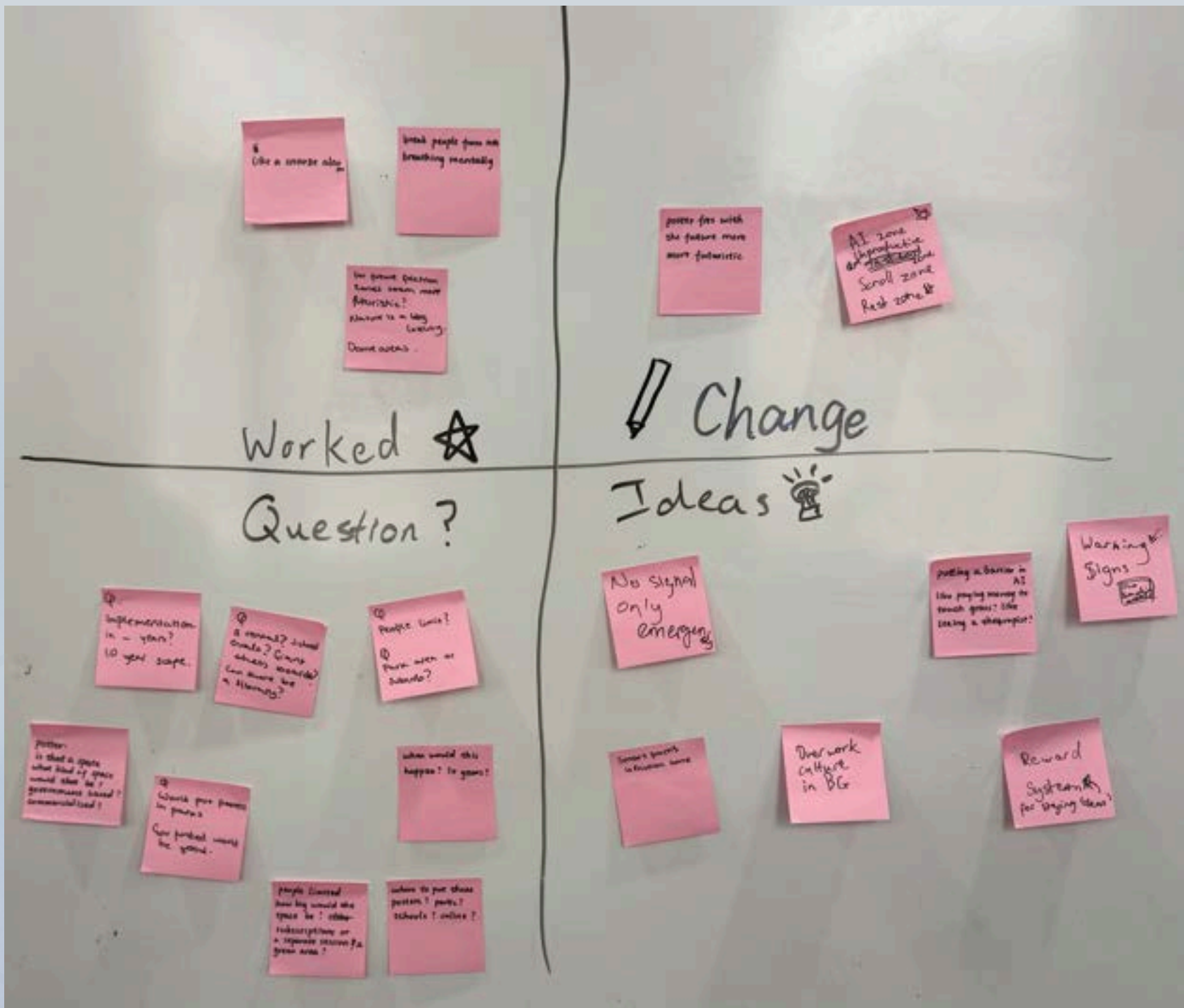
Artefact from the Future

A snapshot of what a 'Friction Zone' will look like in the future
(without annotations)

Artefact from the Future

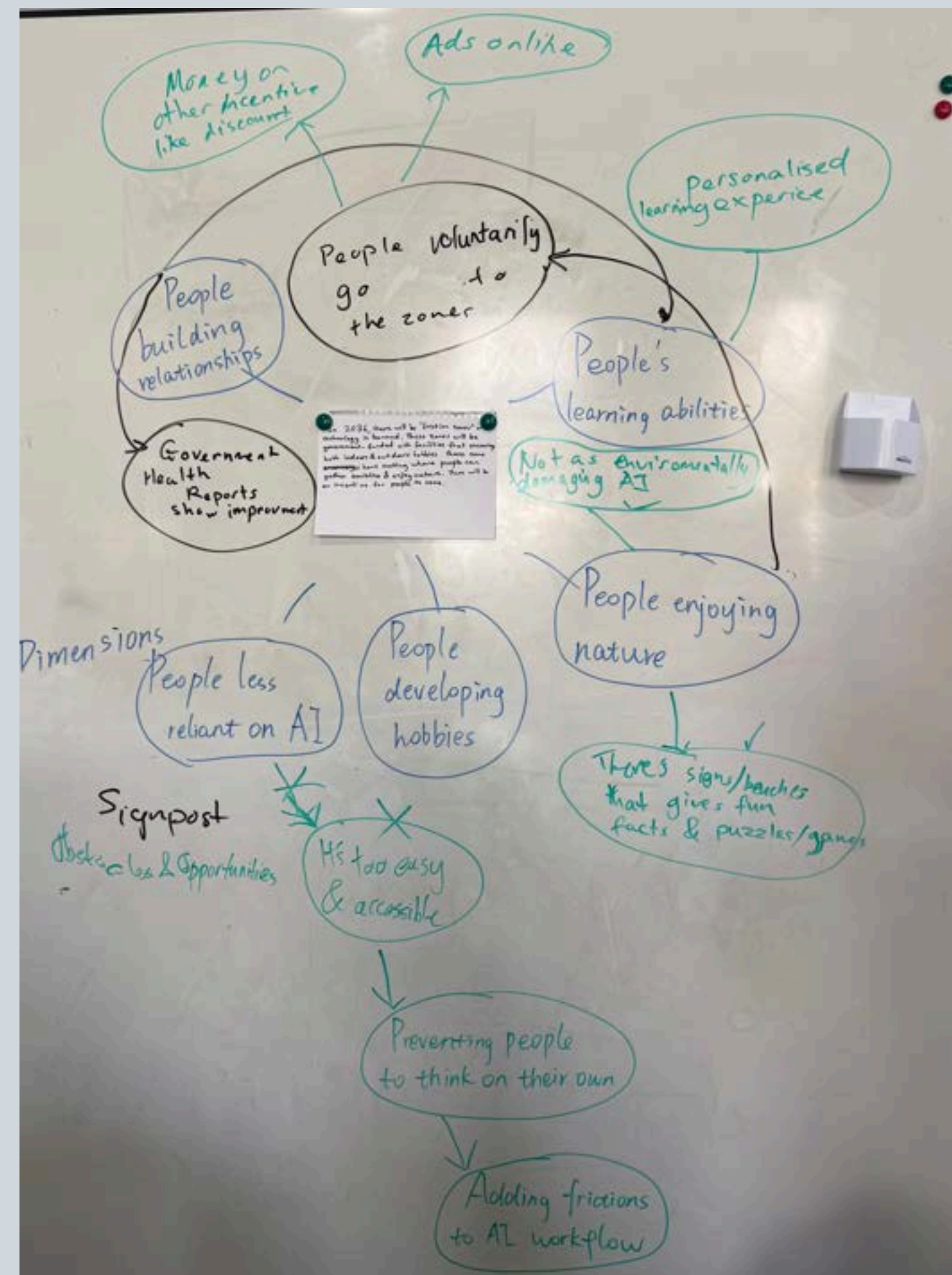


Feedback from another group about the artefacts we made

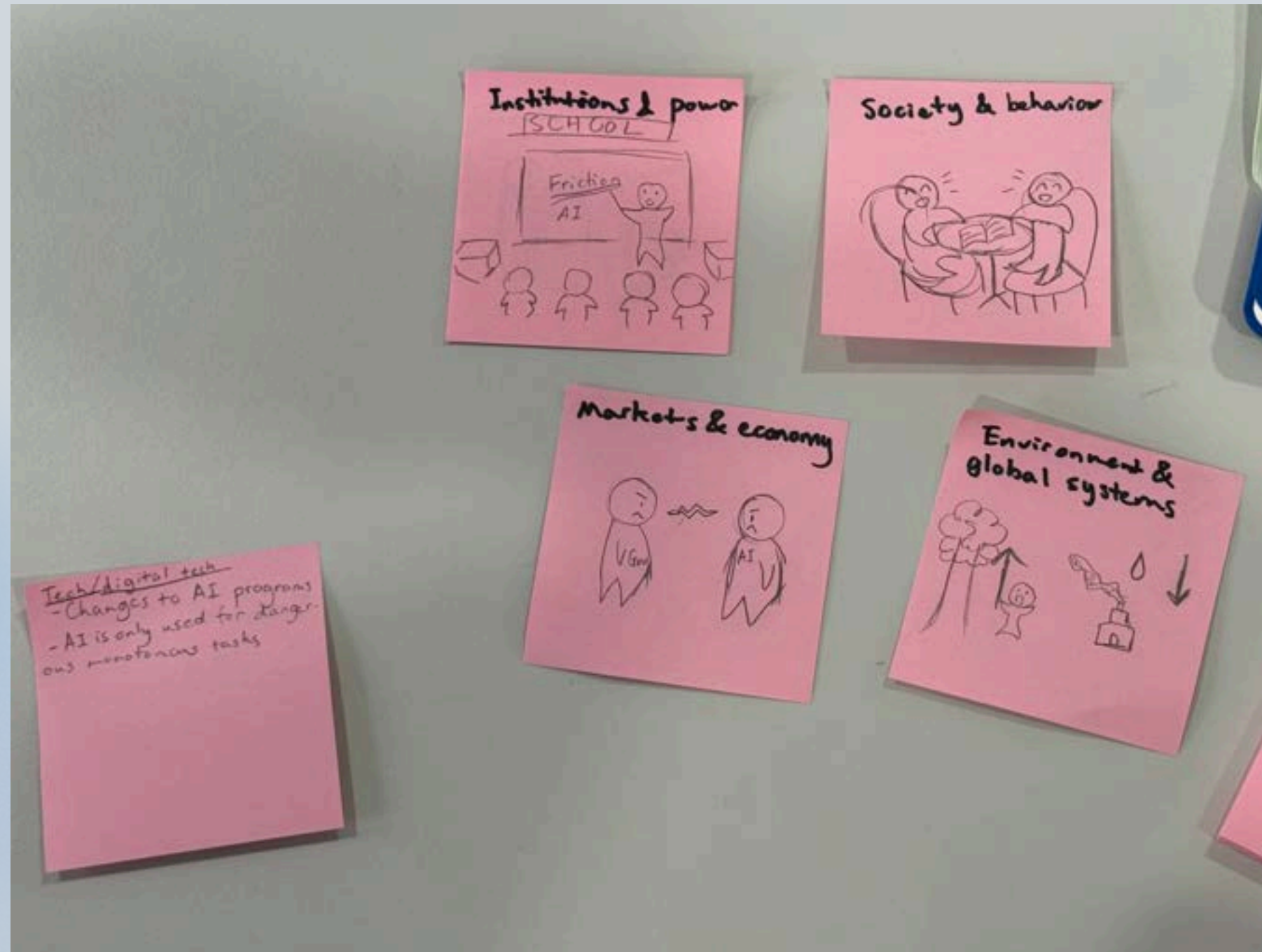


Artefact from the Future

Impacts of Tech



Results from Backcasting activity



Sketches from "Reflect on your preferred future" activity

Tech Implications